

City of Orange Township – City Council
Conference Meeting Minutes – February 17, 2026

MINUTES CITY COUNCIL – CITY OF ORANGE TOWNSHIP, NEW JERSEY

THIS IS A CONFERENCE MEETING OF THE MUNICIPAL COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF ORANGE TOWNSHIP HELD AT CITY HALL, 29 NORTH DAY STREET, ORANGE, NEW JERSEY ON TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 17, 2026 AT 7:01PM.

ROLL CALL

Present: Councilmember Kerry J. Coley, East Ward; Councilmember Tency A. Eason, North Ward; Councilmember Quantavia L. Hilbert, West Ward (Arrived at 7:10pm); Council Vice President Weldon M. Montague, III, At-Large; Councilmember Clifford R. Ross, At-Large; Councilmember Jamie B. Summers-Johnson, South Ward; Council President Adrienne K. Wooten, At-Large.

Also Present: Trisha A. Scipio, Deputy Municipal Clerk; Chris M. Hartwyk, Business Administrator; Derrick Brown, Fire Chief; Brian Mooney, Police Chief; Gracia R. Montilus, Esq. City Attorney; Marlin G. Townes, Legislative Research Officer.

The Deputy Clerk announced a Moment of Silence. Councilmember Tency A. Eason dedicated this moment to the legacy of Reverend Jesse L. Jackson, Sr. Council President Adrienne K. Wooten added the lost lives of Black men and women.

MATTERS FOR DISCUSSION

Health Department

Health Officer Vincent DeFilippo provided an update on current public health matters, including measles statistics, respiratory virus trends, TB, and COVID-19. He expressed concern about the potential public health impact of the upcoming World Cup. Upcoming community health initiatives include the Mammogram Truck (appointments: 973-952-6083), a children's vaccine clinic at Orange Park, and March 31st is the final day to receive a flu vaccination for the current season.

Fire Department

Fire Chief Derrick Brown updated Councilmembers on two recent fires: one at 394 Park Avenue caused by a space heater in an apartment without adequate heat, and another at 639 Scotland Road involving a property operating without required permits. He addressed multi-dwelling property concerns and the importance of renters insurance.

Police Department

Police Chief Brian Mooney provided an update on crime statistics (reflecting rollover from 2025 data). He discussed concerns related to overnight permit parking, snow removal police coordination, break-ins involving stolen key fobs to take vehicles, departmental training initiatives, and the impact of speed bumps on police vehicles. Next Police Community Council (PCC) meeting: March 5th.

ORDINANCE

1-2026: An ordinance amending Chapter 98 of the Municipal Code, entitled "Food Handling Establishments." This Ordinance will be Pulled by Administration (new fees not included).

RESOLUTIONS

106-2026: A resolution for the transfer of appropriation reserves.

107-2026: A resolution for emergency temporary appropriations #2 to the calendar year 2026 budget.

108-2026: A resolution authorizing a contract with PFK O'Connor Davies, LLP as municipal auditors, not to exceed \$125,000.00.

118-2026: A resolution Qualifying Vendors for Special Counsel Services for 2026. Councilmember Hilbert inquired whether three attorneys would be representing the Clerk's Office – Business Administrator clarified this only identifies qualified vendors from RFPs.

126-2026: A resolution to contract live poetry services through Elijah Brown/Let It Flow for 2026 monthly poetry events, not to exceed \$3,000.00. Councilmember Clifford R. Ross expressed opposition, stating local college students could potentially provide poetry services at no cost.

ADJOURNMENT

A motion to adjourn was made by Councilmember Jamie B. Summers-Johnson and seconded by Council Vice President Weldon M. Montague, III. Meeting adjourned at 7:47pm.

Approved: March 3, 2026

Trisha A. Scipio, Deputy Municipal Clerk

Adrienne K. Wooten, Council President